

SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA & INDIAN OCEAN

Country Plans & Org Charts

N G S C Z W

Nigeria · Seychelles · Zimbabwe

Prepared for De La Rue plc — Sales Intelligence

March 2026 · Confidential

NG NIGERIA — Org Chart

Central Bank of Nigeria (CBN)



Key Personnel

Name	Title	Notes
Olayemi Cardoso	Governor	Appointed Sep 2023 by President Tinubu. "Transparency" approach, bank recapitalisation agenda.
Adebisi Sonubi (interim)	Acting Deputy Governor (Operations)	Served as interim governor Jun 2023 before Cardoso's appointment
Elizabeth Kwaghe	Former Director of Currency Operations	First woman to hold the post (2019). Signature on 2024 notes.
Mohammed-Jamiu Olayemi Solaja	Director of Currency Operations	Signature on 2024-2025 notes
Adetona Sikiru Adedeji	Director of Currency Operations	Signature on 2025 notes (current)

Nigerian Security Printing and Minting Company (NSPM)

Detail	Information
Location	Abuja, Nigeria
Ownership	CBN 90%, De La Rue 1%, others
MD	Ahmed Halilu
Role	Domestic printer of naira banknotes and coins
Capacity	Limited — 2022 redesign required external support

🔗 **Critical DLR link:** De La Rue holds a 1% stake in NSPM and was engaged to redesign the 2022 naira notes. De La Rue is the original designer of Nigerian currency. NSPM suggested DLR for the redesign due to capability alignment with local machinery.

POPULATION 230M+	GDP \$475B	CURRENCY NGN (Naira)	INFLATION ~29%	FX RESERVES \$46.7B	PRINTER NSPM (DLR 1%)
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Banknote Denominations — Current Series

Denomination	Colour	Size	Substrate	Status	Key Features
₦5	Green/grey	130 × 72	Polymer (2009+)	Circulating	Alhaji Aliyu Mai-Bornu
₦10	Grey/red	130 × 72	Polymer (2009+)	Circulating	Alvan Ikoku
₦20	Green	130 × 72	Polymer (2007+)	Circulating	Gen. Murtala Mohammed
₦50	Blue	130 × 72	Polymer (2009+)	Circulating	Various national figures
₦100	Brown/purple	151 × 78	Paper	Circulating	Chief Obafemi Awolowo, Zuma Rock
₦200	Green	151 × 78	Paper	Circulating (old + redesigned 2022)	Sir Ahmadu Bello
₦500	Blue/grey	151 × 78	Paper	Circulating (old + redesigned 2022)	Dr. Nnamdi Azikiwe
₦1,000	Red/green	151 × 78	Paper	Circulating (old + redesigned 2022)	Mai-Bornu & Isong. Holographic strip.

Key Currency Intelligence

- **2022 Redesign Crisis:** CBN under Emefiele redesigned ₦200, ₦500, ₦1,000 — led to severe cash crisis, street protests, and Supreme Court intervention
- **De La Rue designed the 2022 redesign** — engaged by NSPM/CBN for the work
- **Lower denominations (₦5-₦50):** Polymer banknotes since 2007-2009 (CBN later said no more polymer — higher costs, environmental issues)
- **Higher denominations (₦100-₦1,000):** Paper (cotton) substrate
- **eNaira:** CBDC launched Oct 2021 — adoption remains limited
- **Massive cash economy:** 230M+ population, significant unbanked population
- **Naira at ~₦1,600/USD** (collapsed from ₦460 in 2023 after float)
- **Bank recapitalisation deadline:** 31 March 2026 — ₦500B for international banks

DLR Opportunity Assessment

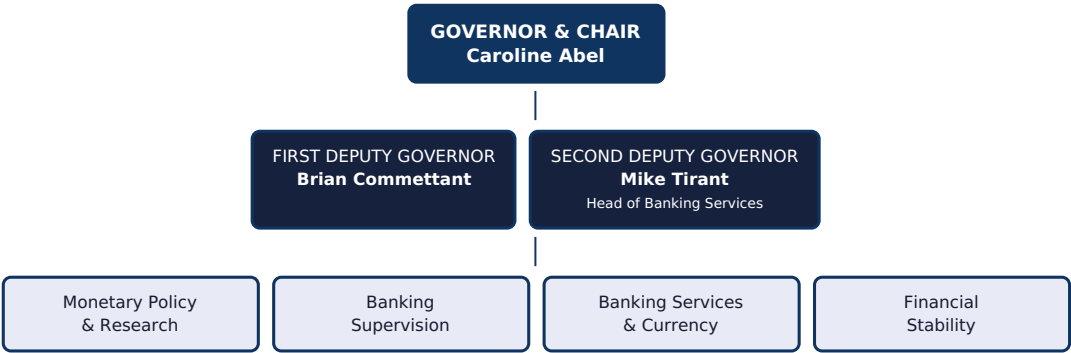
♣ HIGHEST PRIORITY — Established Relationship:

- **1% ownership in NSPM** — existing structural relationship
- **Original currency designer** — designed 2022 redesign, deep institutional knowledge
- **230M+ population** — Africa's largest banknote market by volume
- **Massive demand:** High inflation + large cash economy = constant need for fresh notes
- **New governor (2023):** Cardoso bringing transparency/reform agenda — opportunity for formal engagement
- **NSPM capacity limitations:** Domestic printer needs DLR support for redesigns and capacity overflow
- **Substrate, security features, design services:** Ongoing pipeline
- **₦5,000 denomination:** Under consideration since 2012 — would require new design work

Challenges:

- 2023 currency crisis caused political backlash — sensitivity around redesigns
- CBN abandoned polymer citing costs/environmental concerns
- EFCC investigation into Emefiele era — governance scrutiny
- FX volatility may affect procurement budgets

Central Bank of Seychelles (CBS)



Board of Directors

Name	Role
Caroline Abel	Governor & Chairperson
Brian Commettant	First Deputy Governor
Mike Tirant	Second Deputy Governor (Banking Services)
Prof. William Ogara	Non-Executive Director
Dr. Sherley Marie	Non-Executive Director
Mr. James Jean	Non-Executive Director
Mr. Jean-Paul Barbier	Non-Executive Director

Governance: Governor & DGs appointed by President of Seychelles in consultation with non-executive directors. 6-year terms, max 2 terms. Board meets monthly (min 8x/year). Staggered appointments for continuity.

SC

SEYCHELLES — Country Plan

POPULATION ~100K	GDP ~\$2.1B	CURRENCY SCR (Rupee)	INFLATION ~2.3%	EXCHANGE RATE ~14 SCR/USD	PRINTER De La Rue ✓
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Banknote Denominations — Current Series (2016 Biodiversity Series)

Denomination	Theme	Substrate	Printer	Key Security	Status
R25	Seychelles Biodiversity	Paper	De La Rue	Gemini™ UV feature, holographic patch	Circulating
R50	Aldabra rail (flightless bird)	Paper	De La Rue	Holographic sailfish→50, fluorescent thread	Circulating
R100	Seychelles giant tortoise	Paper	De La Rue	Gold holographic sailfish→100, colour-shifting thread	Circulating
R500	Seychelles scops owl	Paper	De La Rue	Gold holographic sailfish→500, colour-shifting thread	Circulating

R10: Converted from banknote to coin in 2016 series. No longer issued as a note.

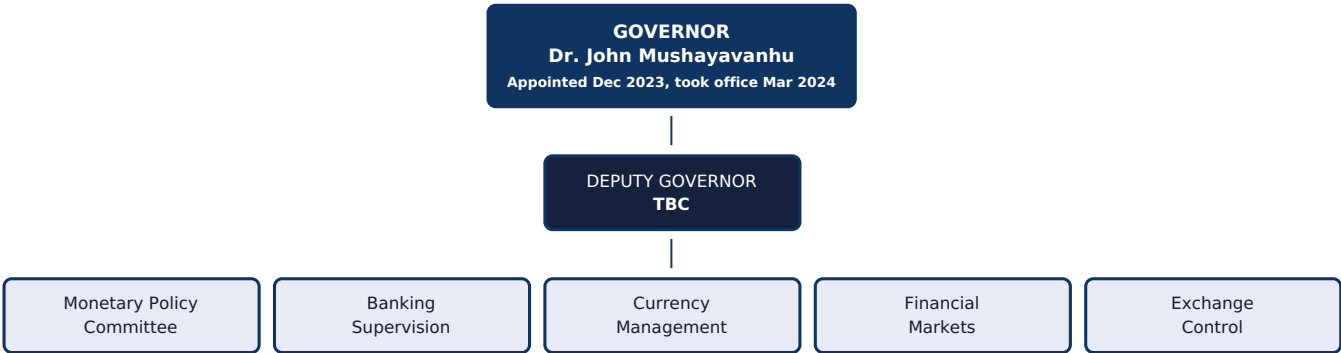
Key Currency Intelligence

- **De La Rue is the INCUMBENT SUPPLIER** — prints all Seychelles banknotes
- **De La Rue Gemini™ technology** deployed on all notes (fluoresces UV, normal daylight appearance)
- **2016 series:** "Seychelles' Unique Biodiversity" themed — cost ~SR 35 million (~\$2.6M) to produce
- **Previous upgrades:** 2011 (R50, R100, R500 security upgrade — holographic patches)
- **Smallest independent monetary policy by population globally**
- **Tourism-driven economy** — high USD/EUR circulation alongside rupee
- **Only 4 denominations** in circulation (small market by volume)
- **Currency floated since 2008** (previously pegged to basket)

DLR Opportunity Assessment

✓ EXISTING CLIENT — Relationship Management:
• De La Rue is the printer — focus on retention and upselling • Gemini™ technology deployed — DLR proprietary features in use • Next series upgrade: 2016 series now 10 years old — upgrade cycle approaching (~2026-2028) • Polymer proposal: Could offer enhanced durability for tropical climate • Security feature upgrades: New generation holograms, threads
Considerations:
• Very small market (~100K population, 4 denominations) — low volume • Limited revenue opportunity per contract cycle • But: high-value reference client, stable relationship, good margins on small runs

Reserve Bank of Zimbabwe (RBZ)



Key Personnel

Name	Title	Notes
Dr. John Mushayavanhu	Governor	Appointed by President Mnangagwa. Background in banking (FBC Holdings). Launched ZiG currency April 2024.
Prof. Mthuli Ncube	Minister of Finance	Works with RBZ on monetary policy statements
John Mangudya	Former Governor	Served May 2014 – April 2024. Now CEO of Mutapa Investment Fund.

⚠ **Context:** Zimbabwe's 6th currency attempt since 2008. Controversial appointment — business ties with President Mnangagwa. ZiG launched April 2024, lost ~50% value in first 6 months, now stabilising.

POPULATION ~16.5M	GDP ~\$30B	CURRENCY ZWG (ZiG)	INFLATION 3.8% (Feb 2026)	EXCHANGE RATE ~26 ZiG/USD	GOLD RESERVES BACKING \$1.2B (end 2025)
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ZiG Banknote Denominations

Original Series (April 2024)

Denomination	Colour	Size	Design	Status
ZiG 10	Navy blue	155 × 65	Domboremari rocks / gold bars	Circulating (being withdrawn)
ZiG 20	Peach/green	155 × 65	Domboremari rocks / gold bars	Circulating (being withdrawn)
ZiG 1, 2, 5	Blue, Green, Pink	155 × 65	Same design	Cancelled → issued as coins instead
ZiG 50, 100, 200	Brown, Olive, Red	155 × 65	Same design	Never issued — postponed May 2024

NEW "BiG 5" Series (April 2026) — CURRENT DEVELOPMENT

Denomination	Animal	Reverse Landmark	Security Features	Release Date
ZiG 10	Buffalo	Matopo Hills	Intaglio, magnetic thread "ZiG10", PEAK device, latent image, colour-shift	7 April 2026
ZiG 20	Elephant	Parliament Building	Intaglio, magnetic thread "ZiG20", PEAK device, latent image, colour-shift	7 April 2026
ZiG 50	Rhinoceros	TBC	Intaglio, magnetic thread "ZiG50", PEAK device, latent image	7 April 2026
ZiG 100	Leopard	TBC	Rolling Star magnetic thread "ZiG100", colour-shift gold→green	Later 2026
ZiG 200	Lion	TBC	Intaglio, colour-shifting gold bars	Later 2026

Key Currency Intelligence

- **NEW SERIES LAUNCHING 7 APRIL 2026** — "BiG 5" redesigned ZiG notes with Big Five wildlife
- **Gold-backed currency:** Claimed \$1.2B in reserves (up from \$276M at launch)
- **Multi-currency system:** USD accounts for ~70-85% of transactions (down from 85% at ZiG launch)
- **Inflation falling:** 4.1% (Jan 2026) → 3.8% (Feb 2026) — lowest in ~30 years
- **6th currency attempt since 2008** — public trust is the fundamental challenge
- **Original 2024 ZiG notes:** Complaints of fading/tearing — drove the redesign
- **Enhanced security:** Intaglio printing, magnetic threads, colour-shifting elements, PEAK devices
- **Graduated sizes:** New series features different sizes per denomination + tactile lines for sight-impaired
- **Printer unknown** — "Fidelity Printers" (domestic, linked to Fidelity Gold Refinery/RBZ)
- **\$21B external debt** (Nov 2024) — fiscal constraints

DLR Opportunity Assessment

- ♣ **HIGH PRIORITY — Active Opportunity:**
- **NEW SERIES LAUNCHING NOW (April 2026):** BiG 5 series — if not already contracted, opportunity for supply/components
 - **Enhanced security demand:** Intaglio, magnetic threads, colour-shifting — DLR capabilities align
 - **Higher denominations pending:** ZiG 100 and 200 still to be released — second phase opportunity
 - **Currency stabilising:** Inflation at 30-year lows, reserves growing — conditions improving
 - **Substrate quality issues:** Original notes faded/tore — quality substrate supplier needed
 - **Full banknote supply:** If domestic capacity insufficient
 - **Security features:** Thread, hologram, colour-shift elements procurement

Challenges:

- 6th currency in 18 years — long-term viability uncertain
- ZiG lost 50% value in first 6 months (now stabilising)
- \$21B external debt — payment risk
- USD dominance (70-85% of transactions) limits ZiG demand
- Political governance concerns around RBZ independence
- Sanctions context may complicate engagement

Comparative Summary

Metric	NG Nigeria	SC Seychelles	ZW Zimbabwe
Central Bank	Central Bank of Nigeria (CBN)	Central Bank of Seychelles (CBS)	Reserve Bank of Zimbabwe (RBZ)
Governor	Olayemi Cardoso (Sep 2023)	Caroline Abel	Dr. John Mushayavanhu (Mar 2024)
Currency	NGN (Naira)	SCR (Rupee)	ZWG (ZiG — Zimbabwe Gold)
Population	230M+	~100K	~16.5M
GDP	\$475B	\$2.1B	\$30B
Denominations	₦5–₦1,000 (8 denoms)	R25, R50, R100, R500	ZiG 10–200 (5 denoms)
Substrate	Polymer (low) + Paper (high)	Paper	Paper
Current Printer	NSPM (DLR 1% stake)	De La Rue ✓	Domestic (Fidelity Printers?)
DLR Relationship	Designer + 1% NSPM stake	Sole printer	Unknown — opportunity
New Series	2022 redesign (DLR designed)	2016 (DLR printed)	BiG 5 — April 2026
Cash Economy	Very high (large unbanked)	Moderate (tourism-heavy)	70-85% USD transactions
DLR Priority	HIGHEST (volume + existing link)	Retention (existing client)	HIGH (active opportunity)

Strategic Recommendations

- Nigeria — Deepen existing relationship:** Largest African market, DLR has 1% NSPM stake + designed 2022 notes. Engage Cardoso administration on ongoing substrate/security supply. Explore ₦5,000 denomination design.
- Zimbabwe — Immediate opportunity:** BiG 5 series launching April 2026 with advanced security features. If not already contracted, engage urgently on components (threads, colour-shift). Higher denominations still pending.
- Seychelles — Retain and upsell:** DLR is sole printer. 2016 series approaching 10-year mark — propose next-generation upgrade with enhanced security. Small but high-margin, stable client.